



**College, Career, and Community Writer's Program
Student Using Sources Tool**

(Check one) _____ Peer Response _____ Self Review

Writer's Name: _____ **Draft number:** _____

Responder's Name: _____ **Date/Class period:** _____

1. Read through the entire piece of writing. ☐ *Check when complete*

2. Read the piece of writing a second time. As you re-read, annotate or highlight the claim(s), source material, and commentary. ☐ *Check when complete*

3. Does the writing present a claim?

- ___ The writing presents a claim that is nuanced, debatable, and defensible.
- ___ The writing presents a claim that is debatable and defensible.
- ___ The writing attempts a claim and/or presents a summary statement about source material, but that statement is not debatable.
- ___ The writing does not present a claim.

4. Does the writing include information from other sources?

- ___ The writing includes three or more sources to support the claim.
- ___ The writing includes two sources to support the claim.
- ___ The writing includes one source to support the claim.
- ___ The writing includes no source material to support the claim.

5. Does the writing include source material to present multiple perspectives?

- ___ The writing includes source material to present multiple perspectives.
- ___ The writing includes source material to present pro and con perspectives.
- ___ The writing includes source material to present a single perspective.
- ___ The writing does not include source material.

6. Can you tell the difference between writing that belongs to the writer and writing that comes from source material?

- ___ The writing consistently includes quotation marks, signal phrases, or clear paraphrasing to indicate the use of source material.
 - ___ The writing sometimes includes quotation marks, signal phrases, or paraphrasing to indicate the use of source material.
 - ___ The writing's use of quotation marks, signal phrases, and/or paraphrasing is unclear.
 - ___ The writing does not use source material.

7. Does the writing characterize the credibility of the sources?

- ___ The writing consistently characterizes the credibility of the sources.

- ☐ The writing sometimes characterizes the credibility of the sources.
- ☐ The writing does not attempt to characterize the credibility of the sources.
- ☐ The writing does not use sources.

8. Does the writing's commentary connect the source material to the claim?

- ☐ The commentary consistently includes analysis that shows how the source material connects to and supports the claim.
- ☐ The commentary sometimes includes analysis that shows how the source material connects to and supports the claim.
- ☐ The commentary summarizes the source material and/or offers little analysis to connect to the claim.
- ☐ The writing contains no commentary on source material.

9. Does the organization of the writing contribute to the overall structure of the argument?

- ☐ The writing is thoughtfully organized and the ideas are logically connected. I can easily follow the structure of the argument.
- ☐ The writing is mostly organized. I can mostly follow the structure of the argument, but I am sometimes confused.
- ☐ The writing is somewhat organized. I am often confused by the structure of the argument.
- ☐ The structure of the argument is unclear.

10. Does the writing use source material for any of the following purposes?

Circle all that apply.

***Illustrating** – Using specific examples from the text to support the claim*

***Authorizing** – Referring to an “expert” to support the claim*

***Extending** – Putting your own “spin” on terms and ideas you take from other texts*

***Countering** – “Pushing back” against the text in some way (e.g., disagree with it, challenge something it says, or interpret it differently)*

None of the above

NEXT STEPS for REVISION:

Based on your reading and your responses above, identify the one or two revisions that will improve this argument the most. Consider the claim, use of source material, and commentary.
